

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 1084

By Todd

A RESOLUTION to honor and commend the Agricultural Crime Unit of the Tennessee Department of Agriculture upon the celebration of its twenty-fifth anniversary.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should pause to specially recognize those governmental entities and public servants whose dedication and professionalism safeguard the welfare, property, and livelihoods of the citizens of this State; and

WHEREAS, the Agricultural Crime Unit of the Tennessee Department of Agriculture proudly celebrated twenty-five years of exemplary service to the people of Tennessee in 2025, marking a quarter century of steadfast commitment to protecting the State's agricultural resources; and

WHEREAS, established in 2000, the Agricultural Crime Unit operates statewide with ten highly trained officers who specialize in the investigation of crimes uniquely affecting the agriculture and forestry sectors, including livestock theft, farm equipment theft, timber theft, wildland fire arson, animal cruelty, and agricultural fraud; and

WHEREAS, under the capable leadership of Special Agent in Charge Greg Whitehead, the members of the Agricultural Crime Unit have demonstrated exceptional professionalism, integrity, and dedication in the performance of their duties; and

WHEREAS, the Agricultural Crime Unit works in close partnership with local, State, and federal law enforcement agencies, prosecutors, and agricultural organizations to ensure that those who prey upon Tennessee's farming and forest communities are brought to justice; and

WHEREAS, the Agricultural Crime Unit has played a critical role in disaster response efforts across the State, including its significant involvement following Hurricane Helene in East

Tennessee in 2024, when its officers worked diligently to assist impacted farmers during a time of great need; and

WHEREAS, through its vigilance and service, the Agricultural Crime Unit of the Tennessee Department of Agriculture has strengthened rural safety, preserved valuable agricultural resources, and upheld the proud farming and forestry tradition that remains a cornerstone of Tennessee's identity; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor and commend the Agricultural Crime Unit of the Tennessee Department of Agriculture upon the celebration of its twenty-fifth anniversary and extend to its officers our sincere appreciation for their years of dedicated service to the people of this State.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.